

# BUYERS' GUIDE

ESTYLE

## The Right ROBOT CLEANER For Your Home



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**D**omestic robots are a great option to perform boring house-cleaning tasks like vacuum cleaning and mopping. These are available in many different configurations. So you can select one that best fits your needs. This article guides you to make the best selection based on a number of factors and specifications.

### Your housing setup

**Size of your premises.** Assess the area that the robot has to clean. Robots map and plan their navigation route within the area before starting to clean. Moreover, robots have a specified threshold for area coverage on a single battery charge. For homes under 140sq.m (1500sq.ft) in size, low-end robot cleaners costing up to ₹ 15,000 will do fine. Bigger apartments require robots with a longer coverage range, better mapping capability and longer battery life. Naturally, these robots are costlier too.

**Flooring and carpets.** Floor type determines the kind of cleaning required for effective results. Robot cleaners perform well on most types of hard floors. However, if a household has carpeting on the floor, feature requirements for the robot go up. Transitioning logic helps the robot to adjust its position and cleaning style. Additionally, vacuum cleaning of the carpets requires a higher suction power. Some carpet types like plush carpets and high-pile sag carpets are better cleaned manually.

**Staircase and obstacles.** Does your house have obstacles like small objects/structures and staircases that the robot will need to manoeuvre around while cleaning? Height of floors throughout

your home and clearance area under furniture are the other factors to consider. If you want the robot to clean under your bed and other furniture, you need to tally its height against the clearance area below the furniture to ensure that the robot can go underneath the furniture.

### Features to look for

The best bet is a robot that can do both dry cleaning as well as wet cleaning—dirt and dust collection, as well as water-mopping. Here are the specifications you should closely pay attention to before making the purchase:

**Power consumption.** Power consumption in watts indicates the robot cleaner's suction and cleaning power. Devices drawing higher power have stronger suction capability. However, higher power consumption will increase your electricity bill too. While robots consume 20-24 watts on an average, those with higher cleaning capacity can consume up to 40 watts of power.

**Trash collection bin and water tank size.** To cover your entire area in one go, ensure that your robot does not run out of space for collecting the dirt or carrying enough water. The dustbin size ranges between 200ml and one litre. Go for a bigger size within this range. The recommended dustbin volume for big premises is at least 500ml. The average size of the water tank is 250ml.

**Floor mapping and safety sensors.** Good-quality robots have sensors and programmed controllers for all kinds of functions including floor mapping and coverage, dirt detection, pace control, corner cleaning and stair detection. Floor mapping logic enables the robot to



Exilient ReadyMaid



Milagrow Blackcat 7.0



iRobot Braava 390t